FOOD & BEVERAGE · FIELD CHECKLIST

Bar Opening Checklist

Property _____ Date _____

Team member _____

01 BRIEFING AND READINESS

- ☐ Confirm today's reservations, VIPs, events and expected peak periods
- ☐ Review unavailable items, daily specials and bar 86'd items
- ☐ Review alcohol service rules and know when to involve the manager
- ☐ Review handover notes from the previous shift
- ☐ Check uniform, grooming, hygiene and service tools before handling glassware or garnishes

02 BAR STATION SETUP

- ☐ Clean and organize the service counter before production starts
- ☐ Position shakers, strainers, jiggers, muddlers, bar spoons, knives and peelers
- ☐ Fill clean ice wells and protect ice from contamination
- ☐ Keep service ice separate from any cleaning area
- ☐ Place bar towels, sanitizer, cutting board, waste bins and service napkins correctly
- ☐ Ensure menus are clean, current and available at the bar and service points

03 GARNISHES, JUICES AND PREPARATIONS

- ☐ Prepare citrus wheels, wedges and twists to expected par
- ☐ Prepare herbs, olives, cherries, cocktail onions and picks
- ☐ Check fresh juices, syrups, bitters and mixers for quality and shelf life
- ☐ Cover and label garnishes where required
- ☐ Store all fresh preparations at the correct temperature
- ☐ Replace anything that looks tired, dry or below presentation standard

04 GLASSWARE AND PRESENTATION

- ☐ Polish glassware and check against light for marks or water spots
- ☐ Remove chipped, cracked or cloudy glasses immediately
- ☐ Stock glassware by drink type and expected service volume
- ☐ Prepare coasters, cocktail napkins and stirrers at each service point
- ☐ Check guest stools, counter edge, back bar and visible shelves

05 STOCK AND PAR LEVELS

- ☐ Check house spirits, premium spirits, wines by the glass and bottled beer against par
- ☐ Check draft beer availability and report any line issue before opening
- ☐ Confirm mixers, non-alcoholic options and coffee or tea items if served at the bar
- ☐ Identify backup stock and make sure it is accessible without leaving the bar unattended
- ☐ Log low stock, breakage, missing items and 86'd items before service starts

06 POS, CASH AND TABS

- ☐ Test POS, printers, payment terminals and receipt flow
- ☐ Confirm tab opening procedure, room charge procedure or credit card hold process
- ☐ Check cash float and reset to opening level if used
- ☐ Confirm transfer procedure when a guest moves from bar to restaurant
- ☐ Keep pen, check presenters and payment tools ready

07 FINAL WALK-THROUGH

- ☐ Check lighting, music, temperature and overall atmosphere
- ☐ Confirm bar top, back bar, floor and guest-facing surfaces are clean
- ☐ Confirm bottles are clean, correctly placed and facing forward
- ☐ Confirm bartender or bar team is in position before opening
- ☐ Complete final manager walk-through before the first guest order